Canva Photo Calendar Print Card

geniusjunkie.net

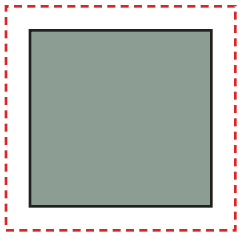
The bleed, the pixels, and the seven checks. Verified 16 October 2026.

THE BLEED - WHY EVERY MONTH PRINTS WITH A WHITE LINE

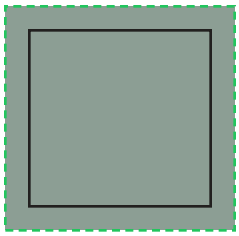
Canva adds 0.125 in (3.175 mm) on all sides - OUTSIDE your page.

Canva: it is added "for products that trim or get cut", and "changing margin, bleed, and crop mark sizes are also not available. These are fixed." Turn it on: File > Settings > Show print bleed.

A photo sized to fit the page is 3 mm short on all four sides. The cut lands past where it ends.
Canva's own fix: "resize or stretch your background to cover them." Drag past the dashed line.



SIZED TO THE PAGE
white sliver, all 12 months



STRETCHED PAST IT
every cut lands on photo

No two copies are trimmed in exactly the same place - so the sliver moves from edge to edge across the twelve months.

It costs 3 mm of picture.

THE PIXELS - CHECK THE LONG EDGE BEFORE YOU CROP

page	300 dpi page	+ Canva bleed
A4 210x297 mm	2480 x 3508	2565 x 3583
A3 297x420 mm	3508 x 4961	3583 x 5036
Letter 8.5x11 in	2550 x 3300	2625 x 3375

RULE OF THUMB: about 2,500 px on the long edge for an A4 page - BEFORE you crop.

Check the pixel dimensions in your file browser, not the megapixels and not how it looks on a phone. A photo straight off a modern phone clears it easily. The ones that fail are the COPIES - anything that came through a messaging app, off social media, or by email. Those are compressed on the way, often to around 1,600 px, and it is invisible on screen.

Too small? Use it inset with a border, or do not use it. Stretching it to fill is what looks cheap in print.

Canva's upload ceiling, at the other end: under 50 MB and no more than 250 million total pixels (JPEG, PNG, HEIC/HEIF, WebP).

THE EXPORT - ONE CORRECT ANSWER

PDF Print Canva: 300 dpi, "with bleed, crop marks, and color profile (RGB or CMYK)". Tick crop marks AND bleed.
NOT Standard 96 dpi - prints soft. And NOT JPG/PNG: 13 separate files, no crop marks on any of them.

Then OPEN the PDF and look at the corners: crop marks outside the page, photo running all the way out to them.
If the photo stops at the page edge, you did not stretch it - go back before you send it.

SEVEN CHECKS BEFORE YOU EXPORT

* **Show print bleed is ON, and every photo is stretched past the dashed line on all four sides**
* Every date sits inside the margin guide
* The first weekday of all twelve months checked against a real calendar
* Every photo was 2,500+ px on its long edge BEFORE you cropped it
* Thirteen pages, including a cover
* The week starts on the same day throughout
* Exported PDF Print with crop marks - not PDF Standard

The first is the one that ruins all twelve months at once - and you cannot see it until they are in the box.